

Kefan Yu

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Education	Northwestern University, Evanston, IL B.S. Computer Science	2022 - 2026 (Expected)
Research Interests	• Evaluation and Interpretability of LLMs • Pragmatics of LLMs • Natural Language Processing	
Publications (*: equal contribution)	Kefan Yu*, Qingcheng Zeng*, Weihao Xuan, Wanxin Li, Jingyi Wu, Rob Voigt, 2025, The Pragmatic Mind of Machines: Tracing the Emergence of Pragmatic Competence in Large Language Models, <i>Preprint</i> Zihan Wang*, Kangrui Wang*, Qineng Wang*, Pingyue Zhang*, Linjie Li*, Zhengyuan Yang, Xing Jin, Kefan Yu, Minh Nhat Nguyen, Licheng Liu, Eli Gottlieb, Yiping Lu, Kyunghyun Cho, Jiajun Wu, Li Fei-Fei, Lijuan Wang, Yejin Choi, Manling Li, 2025, RAGEN: Understanding Self-Evolution in LLM Agents via Multi-Turn Reinforcement Learning, <i>Preprint</i>	
Research Appointments	Toyota Technological Institute at Chicago Research Assistant	June 2025 - Present
	• Working with Zhewei Sun	
	MLL-Lab, Northwestern University Intern	Jan 2025 - Present
	• Working with Zihan Wang and Manling Li	
	LingMechLab, Northwestern University Research Assistant	Feb 2024 - Present
	• Working with Qingcheng Zeng and Rob Voigt	
Teaching	CS336: Design & Analysis of Algorithms Peer Mentor	Spring 2025
	CS449: Deep Learning Peer Mentor	Winter 2024
Industry Experience	CDK Global, Hoffman Estates, IL Software Engineer Intern	June 2024 – Aug 2024